

BEGINNER

Excel Functions Cheat Sheet

The 15 functions that cover 90% of everyday spreadsheet work. Start here if you're new to Excel formulas.

1. Basic Math & Counting

Function	What it does	Example
SUM	Adds up a range of numbers	=SUM(A2:A10)
AVERAGE	Finds the mean of a range	=AVERAGE(B2:B10)
COUNT	Counts cells with numbers	=COUNT(A2:A10)
COUNTA	Counts non-empty cells (any type)	=COUNTA(A2:A10)
MAX / MIN	Largest / smallest value in a range	=MAX(C2:C10)

2. Logic & Conditions

Function	What it does	Example
IF	Returns one value if true, another if false	=IF(B2>100, "High", "Low")
SUMIF	Sums values that meet one condition	=SUMIF(A:A, "West", B:B)
COUNTIF	Counts cells that meet one condition	=COUNTIF(A:A, "West")
SUMIFS	Sums values that meet multiple conditions	=SUMIFS(C:C, A:A, "West", B:B, ">100")
AND / OR	Combine multiple TRUE/FALSE tests	=IF(AND(B2>0, B2<100), "OK", "Check")

3. Lookups (the most useful skill in Excel)

Function	What it does	Example
VLOOKUP	Looks up a value in the first column of a range	=VLOOKUP(A2, Sheet2!A:C, 3, FALSE)
INDEX	Returns a value at a given row/column position	=INDEX(C:C, 5)
MATCH	Returns the position of a value in a range	=MATCH("Delhi", A:A, 0)
INDEX+MATCH	Flexible lookup — looks left, right, works if columns move	=INDEX(C:C, MATCH(A2, A:A, 0))
XLOOKUP*	Modern replacement for VLOOKUP (Excel 365/2021+)	=XLOOKUP(A2, Sheet2!A:A, Sheet2!C:C)

**XLOOKUP needs a recent Excel version. If it's greyed out, use INDEX+MATCH instead — it works everywhere.*

4. Text

Function	What it does	Example
CONCATENATE / &	Joins text from multiple cells	=A2&" "&B2;
TEXTJOIN	Joins text with a separator, skips blanks	=TEXTJOIN(" ", TRUE, A2:A5)
TRIM	Removes extra spaces	=TRIM(A2)
LEFT / RIGHT / MID	Extracts characters from a text string	=LEFT(A2, 3)
UPPER / LOWER / PROPER	Changes text case	=PROPER(A2)

5 Habits That Save You Hours

- Press **Ctrl+Shift+L** to instantly turn a data range into filterable headers.
- Use **Named Ranges** (Formulas → Define Name) instead of raw cell references — formulas become readable.
- Lock a reference with **\$** (e.g. \$A\$1) before dragging a formula down or across, so it doesn't shift.
- Use **Ctrl+`** (backtick) to instantly see every formula in a sheet instead of the results — great for auditing.
- Build one **Pivot Table** before writing ten SUMIFS formulas — it's usually faster and easier to change.

Want the intermediate step up? Grab the DAX & Power Query Cheat Sheet next — it's the natural follow-on once these feel second nature.
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